

(i) $\mathcal{B}$ is a family (a set) of nonempty subsets of X ; that is, every element of $\mathcal{B}$ is a set $B \subset X$. By analogy with the consumer theory to be developed in Chapters 2 and 3, we call the elements $B \in \mathcal{B}$ *budget sets*.

(ii) $C(\cdot)$ is a *choice rule* (technically, it is a correspondence) that assigns a nonempty set of chosen elements $C(B) \subset B$ for every budget set $B \in \mathcal{B}$. When $C(B)$ contains a single element, that element is the individual's choice from among the alternatives in B . The set $C(B)$ may, however, contain more than one element. When it does, the elements of $C(B)$ are the alternatives in B that the decision maker *might* choose; that is, they are her *acceptable alternatives* in B . In this case, the set $C(B)$